

by Mary Aloï

THE TOYBOX BIBLE ADVENTURES

JONAH

and the Big Fish



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The Cast

Sassafras - Zebra (Bible storyteller)

Zoey - Zebra (Physical fitness expert)

Marcie - Zebra (joyful)

Titus - Transforming T. rex (master planner)

Aria - Mermaid

Mia - Black pug (creative type)

Hans - (the Alarm Rooster)



"It's our first ever production of Jonah and the Big Fish!" announced Sassafra, "are you ready?"
"Ready!" said Marcie, with her usual appetite for excitement.

Toybox Bible Adventures



“Wait, wait, this isn’t right. Blue paper!
You want to use blue paper for water?”
Mia was an artist. If it wasn’t believable
she didn’t want any part of it.

“I’m not sure what you want us to do,”
said the mermaid, “we already
agreed—blue paper.”



"Well, then expect our first production to flop!—like a fish," snorted Mia.

"Go with the flow," said Titus.

The puns kept coming.

"You're throwing cold water on our play," laughed Sassafras.

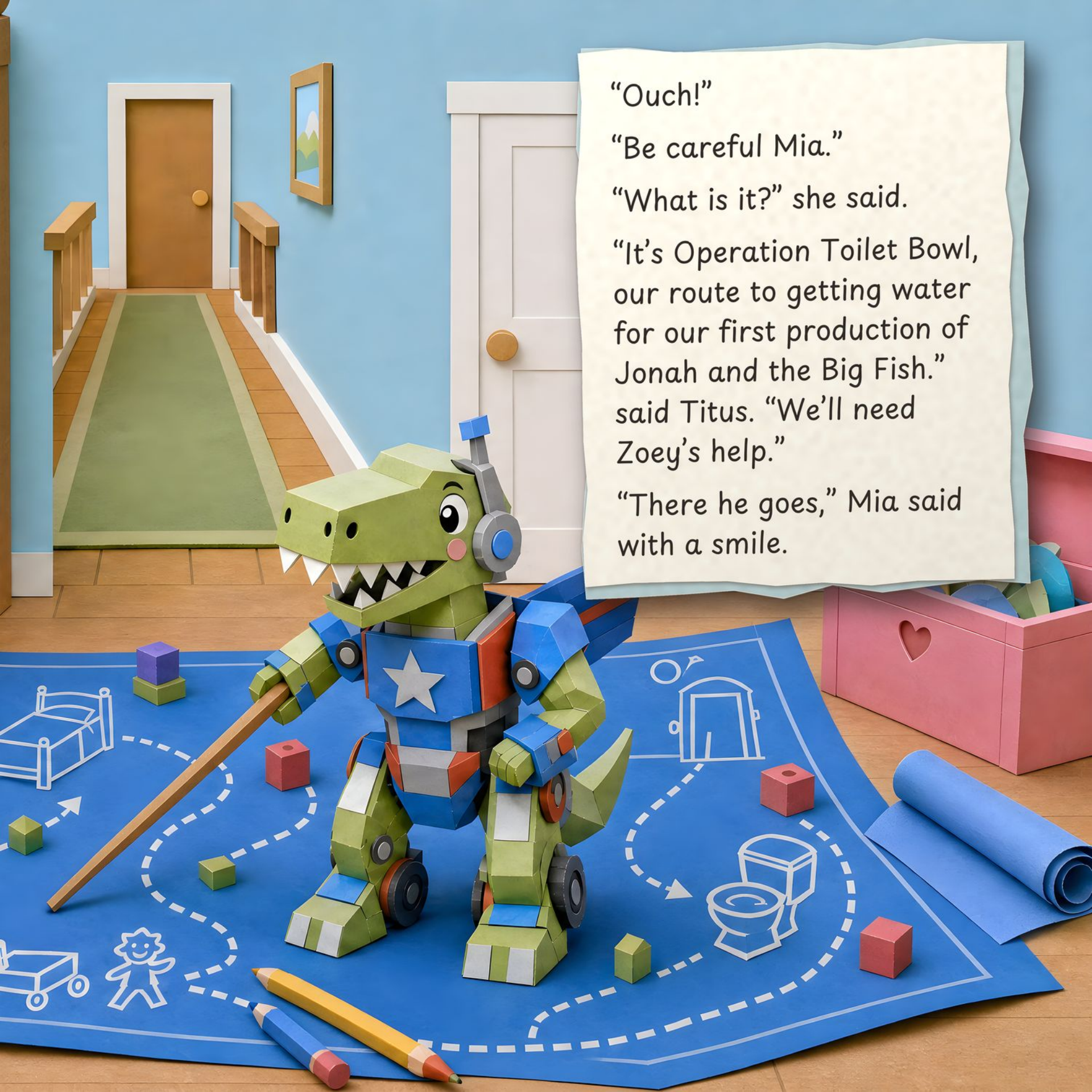


Just then Mia stopped pacing.

“WATER, That’s it! We need REAL WATER.”

Before Hans could crow his morning wake-up call, Operation Toilet Bowl was sprawled out on the bedroom floor of Benny’s room.





"Ouch!"

"Be careful Mia."

"What is it?" she said.

"It's Operation Toilet Bowl, our route to getting water for our first production of Jonah and the Big Fish." said Titus. "We'll need Zoey's help."

"There he goes," Mia said with a smile.

Hans could be heard crowing in
Chloe's room.

Zoey knew that familiar sound
and pulled herself out of Chloe's
toy box.

As the toys gathered around,
Titus gave everyone a job.

"Zoey, we'll need your wagon."



"Mia, you're in charge of making sure the coast is clear."

"Sassafras, do you think you can pull the wagon for us?"

"Yes sir," said Sassafras with confidence.

"Aria, your job could be the most important one today."



And with that, they
headed down the hall.

“Hans, we only have one
hour. Give us the signal
when time is up.”



“There it is,” said Aria, pointing to the bathroom.
When inside everyone took a deep breath.
“Here’s the plan,” said Titus.



"Aria, I'll reach out and place you in the toilet bowl so you can..."

"What!? No! I'm not doing it."

"It's clean water," said Zoey. "Charlie wags his tail every time he takes a drink."



"I'm not a dog,"
announced Aria. "But if
we do this quick, I think I
can get the water."



Just then Mia gave a loud snort from the hallway—it was the signal for danger.

The toys all dove behind the shower curtain, everyone but Aria.

Titus was lowering her into the toilet bowl.



Losing his grip, he
accidentally dropped her in.
Shutting the lid quickly he
dove behind the curtain.

A funny **“HMFFFF!”** came
from the toilet bowl.





Chloe wandered into the bathroom. As she looked into the mirror she made a face.

Grabbing her electric toothbrush, the toys took a deep breath and relaxed.

Sassafras started to giggle. Soon the other toys joined in.



Everyone but Aria.

“HMFFFF!” came from beneath the toilet lid.

“What are we even laughing about?” asked Zoey.

“This reminds me of Jonah and the Big Fish!” Sassafras laughed.



"Why?" asked Marcie.

"Because God asked Jonah to do something he didn't want to do."

Another muffled "HMFFFF!" came from the toilet.

"Just like Aria!" Hans cackled.



“Well... sort of,” said Sassafras.
“God asked Jonah to go to Nineveh. The people there were making terrible choices, and God wanted Jonah to warn them.”

“Did he go?” asked Marcie.

“Nope. Jonah didn’t like the Ninevites. He wanted God to punish them, so he ran the other way and boarded a ship.”



Aria bumped against the toilet lid.

THUMP!

"Jonah's trip got bumpy too," continued Sassafras. "God sent a powerful storm, and the ship tossed back and forth on the waves." Titus rocked from side to side. "Whoa... whoa... **WHOA!**" "Eventually, Jonah was thrown overboard." Hans pointed toward the toilet. "Now this is starting to sound familiar."

H M F F F F !

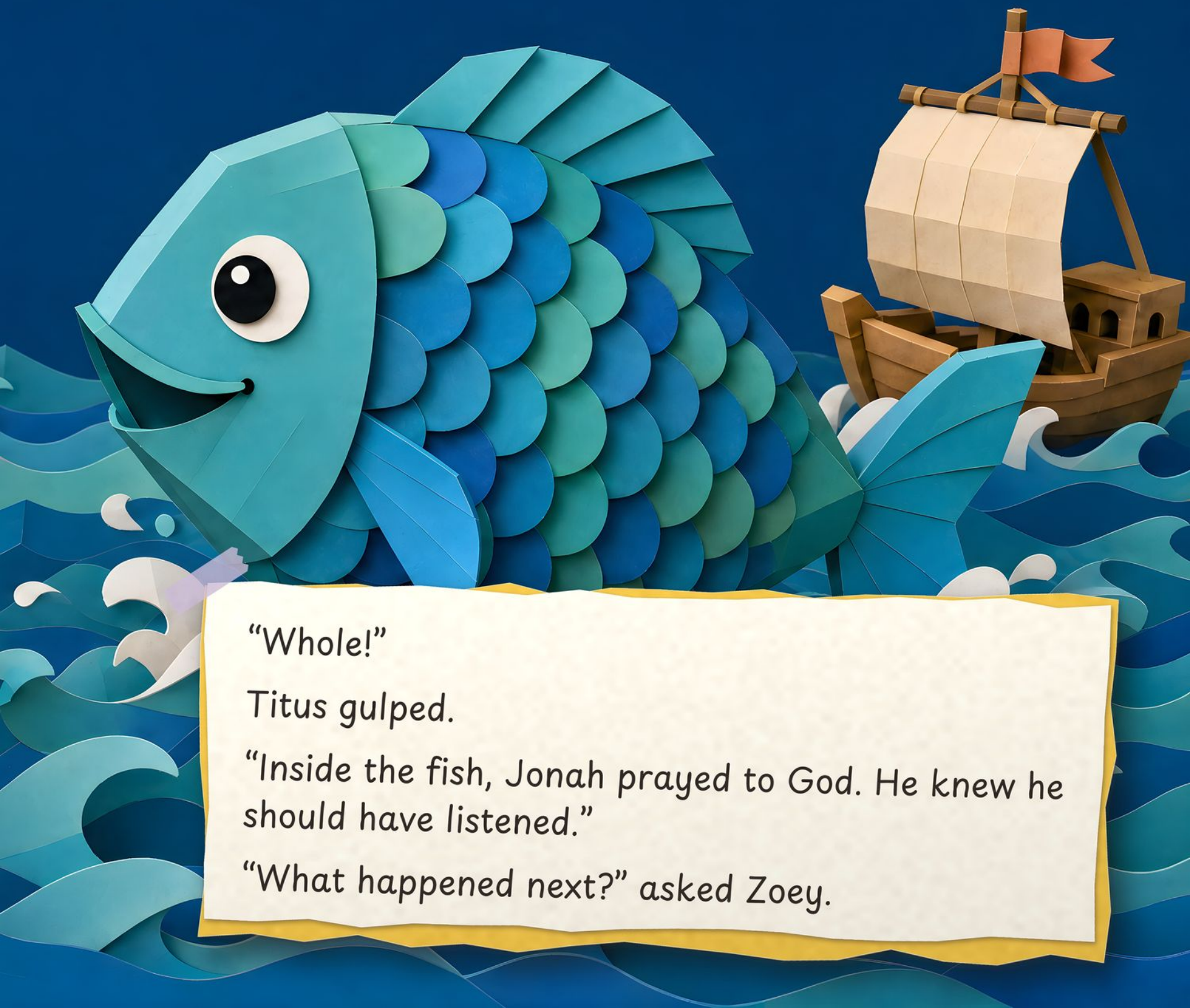


Everyone burst out laughing again.

"But God didn't leave Jonah in the sea,"
Sassafras continued. "He sent a big fish
to swallow him."

Marcie's eyes grew wide. "Swallow him?"





"Whole!"

Titus gulped.

"Inside the fish, Jonah prayed to God. He knew he should have listened."

"What happened next?" asked Zoey.

"After three days and three nights, God told the fish to spit Jonah onto dry land."

"Spit him out?" Mia wrinkled her nose.

"More like vomited," said Sassafra.

"Ewww!"





Hans sounded the all-clear.

Titus hurried to the toilet and
lifted the lid.

Aria popped up, dripping wet.

"I know exactly how Jonah felt!"

Everyone roared with laughter.

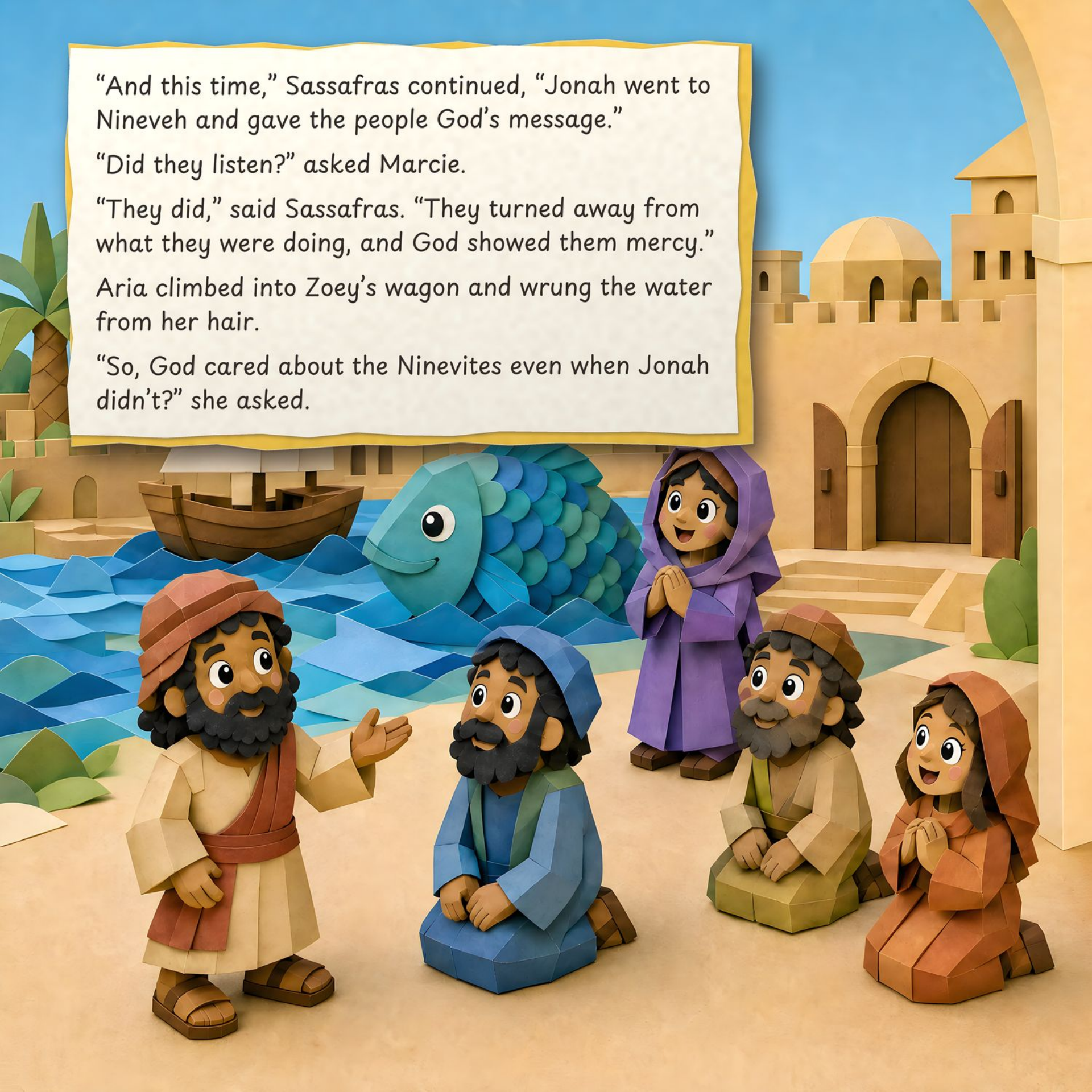
"And this time," Sassafras continued, "Jonah went to Nineveh and gave the people God's message."

"Did they listen?" asked Marcie.

"They did," said Sassafras. "They turned away from what they were doing, and God showed them mercy."

Aria climbed into Zoey's wagon and wrung the water from her hair.

"So, God cared about the Ninevites even when Jonah didn't?" she asked.



Sassafras smiled.
"Exactly."



The toys chuckled as
they pulled their wagon
full of water down the
hall.



"I guess we have our
Jonah," laughed
Sassafras.

Aria rolled her eyes.
Then she smiled.



Later that day, Jonah
and the Big Fish made a
big splash on the stage of
their first ever
production.

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Aria took a bow.

It was the first time they ever
saw a mermaid play Jonah!

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What did we learn?

Jonah learned that God's mercy isn't just for us—it's for others, too.

God gave Jonah a second chance when he disobeyed, and He wanted Jonah to show that same mercy to the people of Nineveh. Sometimes it can be hard to forgive someone who has done wrong, but God wants us to be kind, forgiving, and willing to give others another chance.

Is there someone you can forgive or show kindness to today?

"Instead, be kind to each other, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, just as God through Christ has forgiven you."

Ephesians 4:32 NLT



**The toys need real water for their
first big show.**

There's just one place to get it... and one
very unhappy mermaid.

A laugh-out-loud toy adventure that tells
the true Bible story of Jonah, and of a God
whose mercy is bigger than the sea.

The Toybox Bible Adventures · Ages 3-8